

Build Amazing iOS *and* Android Apps *with* NativeScript

This article explores NativeScript, which is an open source framework for building native apps using JavaScript. NativeScript also supports Angular, Vue.js and TypeScript. Developers can use it to build apps for Android or iOS platforms with the same code.



Mobile phones or smartphones have already made their way into the average person's life, with many using their mobile app as their primary device. No matter whether you run a big business or a startup, not having a mobile presence is simply no longer an option.

With the context already set and assuming you are convinced enough to build your next (or very first) app, I would quickly like to touch upon some of the pain points of mobile app development.

- Whether it's a company launching an app, or a developer doing so, you would want your idea to be accessible to the maximum number of users, but the mobile world, even today, is quite heterogeneous. For example, if you want to target iOS and Android users, using their native technologies, you need a completely different skill set to develop apps for both the platforms. Android native apps are generally built on Java and iOS apps on Swift.
- There are intermediary solutions that allow you to port your Web apps onto mobile devices, but they generally

provide a poor user experience as most users prefer the native look and feel of the device's ecosystem. Besides, the Web app approach does not always provide the best performance, compared to native counterparts.

Introducing NativeScript

NativeScript tries to address many of these issues by allowing developers to build native apps mostly in JavaScript. This is one of the key differentiators between Apache Cordova and NativeScript. The former allows you to write applications in HTML and JavaScript that run inside WebView, and you need to write platform-specific plugins to access native APIs of the device. NativeScript, on the other hand, allows your JavaScript code to natively run on the device providing 0-Day API support for the platform.

So how does NativeScript work?

It is good to know the architectural details if you are an application developer but mostly the NativeScript runtime will take care of most of the low-level complexities for you.